Trading Plan Template

Your complete framework for consistent, disciplined trading.

Trader Name

Date Created

What's Inside

- Section 1: Trading Goals & Identity
- Section 2: Risk Management Rules
- Section 3: Strategy Rules & Setup Criteria
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1 Trading Goals & Identity

Define who you are as a trader and where you want to go. Without clear goals, you have no way to measure progress or know when your plan is working.

My Trading Style

- ☐ Day Trader
- ☐ Swing Trader
- ☐ Scalper
- ☐ Position Trader

Markets I Trade

- ☐ Stocks
- ☐ Options
- ☐ Futures
- ☐ Forex
- ☐ Crypto

My Trading Schedule

Trading Sessions (e.g., 9:30-11:00 AM ET)

Hours Per Day

My Trading Goals

1. Monthly P&L target:
2. Win rate target:
3. Average R:R target:
4. Max trades per day:

Why I Trade (My Motivation)

Pro tip: Write your "why" in your own words. Revisit it on tough days. The traders who survive drawdowns are the ones who remember what they are building toward.

2 Risk Management Rules

Risk management keeps you in the game. Every rule here exists to protect your capital so you can trade tomorrow. Write these down, commit to them, and do not bend them mid-trade.

Account & Position Sizing

Account Size

Max Risk Per Trade (%)

Max Risk Per Trade ($)

Max Daily Loss ($)

Max Weekly Loss ($)

Max Open Positions

Max Correlated Positions

Position Sizing Method

How I calculate position size (e.g., fixed %, ATR-based, dollar risk / stop distance):

Circuit Breakers (When I Stop Trading)

- [ ] Stop after hitting max daily loss
- [ ] Stop after 3 consecutive losses
- [ ] Stop if I catch myself revenge trading
- [ ] Stop if I deviate from my plan

Other circuit breaker:

The 1% rule: Most professional traders risk between 0.5% and 2% of their account per trade. If you are risking more than 2%, you are gambling, not trading.

3 Strategy Rules & Setup Criteria

Define exactly what a valid trade looks like for each strategy you run. If a setup does not match these rules, skip it. Clarity here eliminates the guesswork that leads to impulsive entries.

Strategy 1

Strategy Name:

Description / Pattern:

Timeframe

Min R:R

Best Market Condition

Entry Criteria (what must be true):

Exit Criteria / Profit Targets:

Strategy 2

Strategy Name:

Description / Pattern:

Timeframe

Min R:R

Best Market Condition

Entry Criteria (what must be true):

Exit Criteria / Profit Targets:

Need more strategies? Print extra copies of this page, or track all your setups in TradeZella's Playbook feature where every strategy gets its own performance dashboard.

4 Pre-Market Routine

Your morning routine sets the tone for the day. Rushing into the market unprepared leads to reactive decisions. Build a checklist you can repeat every single session.

Before the Market Opens

- [ ] Review economic calendar and overnight news
- [ ] Mark key support and resistance levels on charts
- [ ] Identify 3-5 potential trade setups from my watchlist
- [ ] Check pre-market movers and unusual volume
- [ ] Review yesterday's trades and lessons
- [ ] Set daily P&L goal and max loss for today
- [ ] Clear my desk, silence my phone, close distractions

Additional pre-market steps (customize for your routine):

My Watchlist Template

Ticker	Setup	Key Level	Bias	Notes

Mental Prep

Today I will focus on:

Today I will avoid:

5 Trade Entry & Exit Rules

Entry and exit rules are the mechanical heart of your plan. Write them so specifically that another trader could follow them without asking you a single question.

Entry Checklist (All Must Be True)

- [ ] Setup matches one of my defined strategies
- [ ] Risk-to-reward ratio meets my minimum (see Section 3)
- [ ] Stop loss is set BEFORE entry
- [ ] Position size calculated based on risk rules (see Section 2)
- [ ] No existing correlated positions exceeding my limit
- [ ] I am not chasing -- price is at or near my planned entry

Additional entry rules:

Exit Rules

Define your exits BEFORE entering. Knowing when to get out is more important than knowing when to get in.

Profit Target 1 (partial exit):

Profit Target 2 (full exit):

Stop Loss Rule:

Trailing Stop Method:

Time-based exit (if applicable):

During the Trade

- [ ] Follow the plan -- do not move stop further away
- [ ] Scale out at pre-defined targets
- [ ] Monitor for thesis invalidation
- [ ] Log emotional state if I feel the urge to override

Moving your stop loss further from your entry to "give it more room" is the single most common way traders turn small losses into account-ending ones. Set it and respect it.

6 Weekly Review Prompts

Set aside 30 minutes every weekend for this review. Traders who review weekly improve faster than traders who only look at P&L. Answer each prompt with specific trades and examples, not general feelings.

Performance Review

Total trades taken this week:

Wins	Losses	Win Rate	Net P&L

What Worked

Best trade this week and why:

Which strategy performed best?

What Needs Work

Worst trade this week and what went wrong:

Did I break any rules this week? Which ones?

Next Week

One thing I will do differently next week:

Confidence level (1-10) and why:

TradeZella automates most of this review. Your performance stats, win rate, P&L by strategy, and equity curve update in real time. Get started at tradezella.com

Skip the Template.

Let Zella AI Build Your Plan.

This template gives you the structure. TradeZella gives you the system.

Auto-import trades from 500+ brokers. Get AI-powered insights.

Track every metric in this template automatically -- and dozens more.

Capability	Template	TradeZella
Manual trade logging	Yes	Yes
Risk management tracking	Yes	Yes
Strategy performance analysis	--	Yes
Auto-import from 500+ brokers	--	Yes
AI-powered trade insights	--	Yes
Trade replay with entries & exits	--	Yes
50+ performance reports	--	Yes
Visual P&L calendar	--	Yes

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